

Tree Planting Committee
Transfer Station, 815 Newton St & 870 Hammond Street
Minutes – April 29, 2014, 5:30 p.m.

Attending: Hugh Mattison (Chair), Nadine Gerds, Brandon Schmitt, Tom Brady (Staff), Peter Jutras (Staff)

Public: None

Staff Update:

Spring 2014 Planting - Tom reported that 210 trees costing about \$22,000 are held in the Nursery for Spring planting. Red Maple, American Elm, Cherry, and Flowering Dogwood are some of the species.



Members of TPC and Tree Warden Tom Brady visit the tree "Nursery" at the Newton Street Transfer Station

Tom will send a list of proposed locations to the Committee (TPC). Nadine suggested that a map of new locations be created; Tom explained that the work order system (Cartegraph) needs to interface with the GIS system. Maintenance of the GIS is out of date, and may require another street tree survey by Town staff. Tom will send a spreadsheet to the Committee of planting locations; the TPC can each review the list and send comments to Tom. Door hangers are placed on abutters' doors to inform them that a tree has been planted. Tom commented that these trees originated in nurseries from North Carolina, Michigan and Pennsylvania. Seasonal labor is used for tree watering for trees planted this spring.

Tom asked the TPC to meet with Toxteth Street neighbors to review a planting plan. A number of White Pines will be planted at Skyline Park.

The meeting was paused to be continued at the DPW facility at 870 Hammond Street.

Continuation:

Tom distributed a list by address of 147 tree locations assigned so far. Another 63 locations have still to be decided. The largest plantings will be Cherry (28), Honeylocust (20), Red Oak (15), Pin Oak (15), London Planes (15), American Elm (14), Forge Elm (14), Sweetgum (12), Linden (10), Zelkova (10), and Sugar Maple (10). Tom asked TPC to look at Coolidge Corner Library to comment on a tree to be planted to the left of the entrance; a larger tree will create shade, but the space is more suitable for a large rather than an ornamental tree. Toxteth Street residents are asking for a number of trees requiring new tree pits to be planted. TPC decided to meet with neighbors and discuss a planting plan. Tom will set up a meeting. [Subsequently, Wednesday, May 28 at 5:30 was decided as the date to meet.]

Over the next 3 weeks, each TPC member will review the planting list locations and send comments to Tom.

Adjourned at 6:35 pm

Prepared and submitted by:

Hugh Mattison
May 16, 2014